

US Military — Role Requirements Overview

Planning guide for common roles across US armed services · Free reference sheet · join-ready.com

Planning reference only. This is an educational planning overview, not an official MEPS or recruiting document. Education, ASVAB, fitness, and medical requirements vary by branch, role, and current recruiting standards. Verify all details with an official military recruiter.

ROLE	BRANCH	EDUCATION	APTITUDE	FITNESS	MEDICAL	NOTES
Infantry	Army / Marine Corps	HS diploma / GED	ASVAB CO score applies	High — combat fitness test	Medical suitability required	Core ground combat role; physical standards are demanding
Cavalry Scout / Recon	Army / Marine Corps	HS diploma / GED	ASVAB ST or CO score	High	Medical suitability required	Reconnaissance and forward operations; vehicle and foot patrol
Military Police / Security Forces	Army / Marine Corps / Air Force / Navy	HS diploma	ASVAB ST score applies	Moderate–High	Medical suitability required	Law enforcement, base security; background investigation required
Combat Medic / Hospital Corpsman	Army / Navy	HS diploma; science courses helpful	ASVAB ST score — higher threshold	Moderate–High	Medical suitability required	Battlefield and clinical medical care; equivalent to EMT-Basic or higher
Cyber Operations / IT Specialist	Army / Navy / Air Force / Space Force / Marine Corps	HS diploma; IT coursework beneficial	ASVAB EL or ST score — high threshold	Standard	Medical suitability required	Security clearance typically required; IT certifications valued
Intelligence Analyst	All branches	HS diploma; strong academics preferred	ASVAB GT score — high threshold	Standard	Medical suitability required	Security clearance required; analytical and language aptitude valued
Logistics / Supply Specialist	All branches	HS diploma / GED	ASVAB CL or GT score	Standard	Medical suitability required	Supply chain, inventory, and distribution; role-dependent training provided
Mechanic / Vehicle Maintenance	All branches	HS diploma; mechanical aptitude helpful	ASVAB MM or EL score	Standard	Medical suitability required	Wheeled and tracked vehicle maintenance; trade qualifications may be earned
Aviation Maintenance	Army / Navy / Air Force / Marine Corps / Coast Guard	HS diploma; maths and science important	ASVAB EL or MM score — higher threshold	Standard	Medical suitability required	Aircraft maintenance and safety-critical work; FAA certification pathways possible
Special Operations Candidate	Army / Navy / Air Force / Marine Corps	HS diploma	ASVAB GT score — high; PAST or similar test	Very High — selection-specific standards	Enhanced medical screening	Selection process separate from basic enlistment; extremely demanding

Based on publicly available US military recruiting information. Requirements vary by branch and change over time.

